

How does sports psychology contribute as a development to an individual in his sports carrier

Reference(APA7)

A sportsman is an individual who is passionate about engaging in one or more sports activities for his/her physical and mental development, which also can contribute to a career in the future. A competitor should definitely develop both his psychological and physical well-being in order to achieve his/her targets in the sport/s they perform. Sportsmen are individuals who are trained and built to be innovative, intelligent, and interactive. They also possess special talents and creativity which set them apart from the individuals who do not perform any sport. Numerous studies have highlighted the importance of sports psychology in enhancing athletes' performance, managing stress and anxiety, and improving team dynamics. For example, a recent systematic review conducted by Lim and colleagues (2022) examined the effectiveness of psychological interventions on athletic performance. The review found that interventions such as imagery, goal-setting, self-talk, and relaxation techniques can significantly enhance athletes' performance and reduce anxiety.

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It has been proved that sportsmen, through their participation in sports, acquire moral attitudes and behavior that make them good characters and role models. These moral attitudes and behavior can be called the ethos of sport, and consist of the principles of fair play and courage, justice, and honesty[Roger Melin Department of Philosophy School of Humanities and

Media Högskolan Dalarna 791 88 Falun, Sweden Email: rme@du.se]An athlete with great qualities and discipline could be respected and treated in a superior manner to people in many other fields. People of all ages, will consider such a sportsman as a guide or a role model and try to imitate the same personality of such a person. This could not only develop skilled sportsmen around the world but also could build good personalities among all the other around the world.

Sportsmen also have a great ability to engage in educational activities according to research done in Russia in the year 2016. Unfortunately, many of the athletes have a misunderstanding about managing educational activities with their sports activities. Which is the misunderstanding built by their family background and the society they associate with.

As sportsmen, athlete could face many challenges that can make their career successful or which can also destroy their career completely. Athletes do have to stop their entire sports career for reasons such as injuries that can not be recovered or injuries that will take a long time to recover. Even the use of steroids or unhealthy supplements can ruin an athlete's life completely. By surpassing all these challenges an athlete can live a happy life.

Sportsmen should learn three main types of training methods that can let them perform their maximum at sports competitions. Sport-based skill training, Physical fitness training, and Sports psychology training are the main types of training methods an individual should follow in their sports career.

Most sports trainers mainly focus on sports-based skill training and physical fitness training but they lack in sports psychology training. The reason for this is the lack of education provided to

sports trainers and coaches. This could result in a great imbalance in an individual's sports career.

Sports psychology training could overcome one of the main challenges of a competitor which is the pressure faced in a sportsman's life due to other people around him/her.

Sports and exercise psychology is the scientific study of people and their behavior in sports and exercise activities and the practical application of that knowledge (Gill, 2000). American, Coleman Griffith is considered to be the father of sports psychology. Sport psychology is the scientific study of people and their behaviours in sport and exercise activities. The aim of the study of sport psychology is to be able to apply the knowledge learned about these to practical uses. Sport psychology is an interdisciplinary science that draws on knowledge from the fields of kinesiology and psychology. It involves the study of how psychological factors affect performance and how participation in sport and exercise affect psychological and physical factors. [**RAVINDRA BALIRAM KHANDARE**

Deparment of Physical Education,
Mula Education Society's Arts,
Commerce and Science College,
Sonai, Tq.Newasa,
AHMEDNAGAR (M.S.) INDIA
]

Historical Background and Evolution

The start of the initial stage of sports psychology was during the early 20th century, as many psychologists became interested in understanding how the minds of athletes affected athletic performance. Coleman Griffith is often considered to be the

father of sports psychology, who in the 1920s conducted some of the first research about sports psychology. He did most of the fundamental work required to understand the psychological components of sport and exercise.

The field has dramatically changed since over the years. For example, Many societies, such as the International Society of Sport Psychology founded in 1965, and the Association for Applied Sport Psychology founded in 1986, had a lot to do with its formalization and growth as a separate discipline. Today, sports psychologists work in academic institutions, with specialized teams, and in private practice.

Key concepts and theories

Key concepts and theories of sports psychology include motivation, exploring what drives and supports athletes performance in their sport. Theories of motivation in sports, including Self-Determination Theory by Deci and Ryan (1985), put forward the role of intrinsic and extrinsic motivation in athletic performance. The intrinsic motivation is concerned with the sport for its own sake and for pleasure and satisfaction obtained from the sport activity itself. The extrinsic motivation includes external rewards such as certificates, trophies, recognition and fame, and financial rewards.

Another very important aspect of study is the arousal and anxiety levels. The Inverted-U Hypothesis describes an optimum amount of arousal where performance is at its prime, while too low and too high levels of arousal have negative effects on performance. Techniques of imagery, relaxation training, and cognitive-behavioral interventions are used to

help deal with the anxiety level of an athlete and maintain an optimal amount of arousal.

Self-confidence and self-efficacy are considered the most important psychological constructs of sport. Self-efficacy is related to Bandura's theory, where belief in one's capability to perform well in specific situations will help him achieve success. High self-efficacy is linked with increased motivation, resilience, and persistence-the necessary factors to be successful in sports. The athletes may be assisted by sport psychologists in enhancing and maintaining self-confidence through the process of goal setting, positive self-talk, and mastery experiences.

Factors related to sports psychology

It is important to analyze the personality of an individual in order to develop psychology related to sports. Previous study about personality shows how the functions of the psychological core, typical responses, and role-related behavior and the ways to develop and change them.

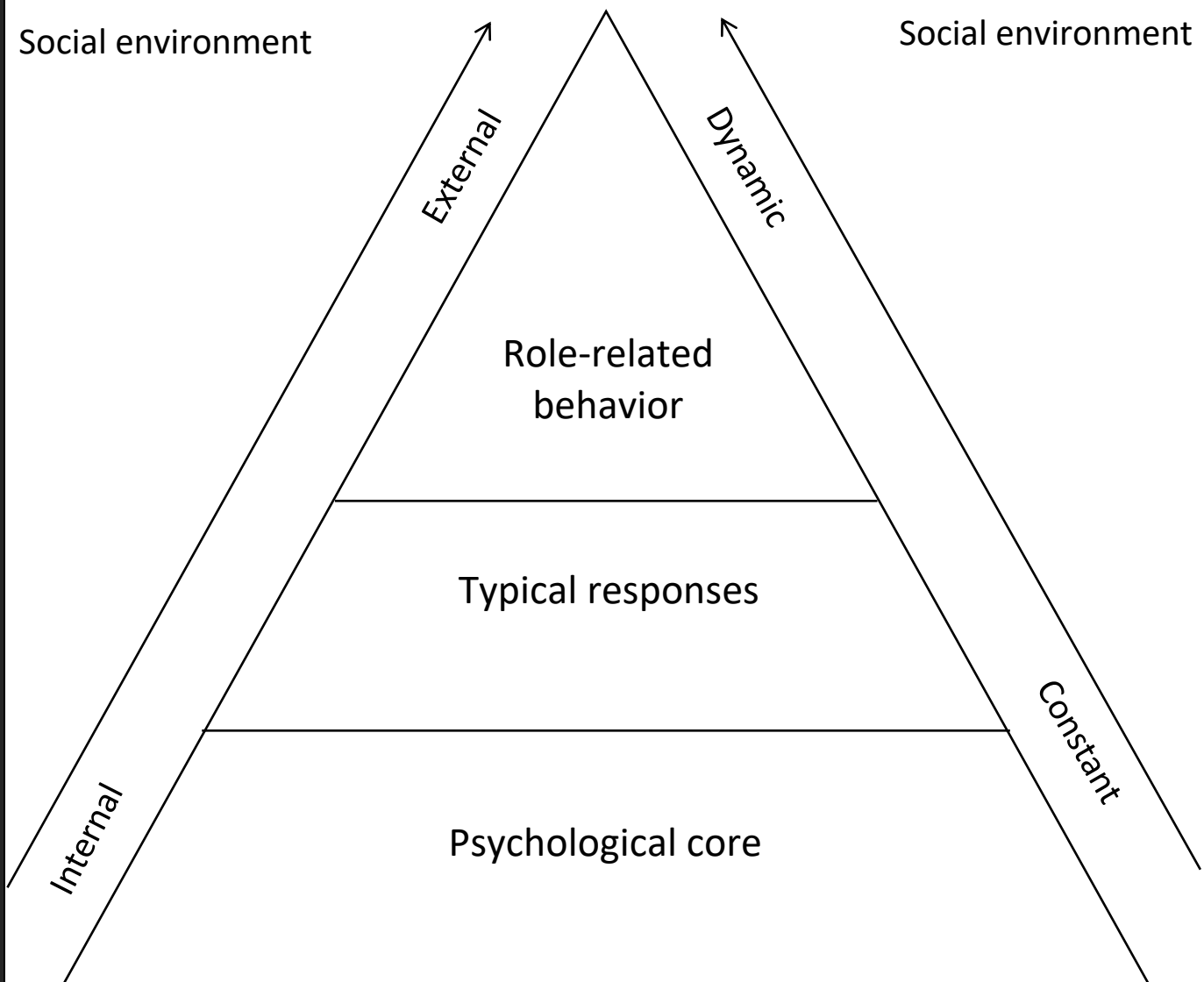
Personality

The sum of characteristics that make a person unique is considered to be the definition of personality. Understanding personality is important to work better with students, athletes, and exercisers.

Personality structure will describe it. It consists of three main parts

1. Psychological core
2. Typical responses
3. Role-related behaviour

Personality



Psychological core

- ❖ It is the most internal part of personality(the most basic level)
- ❖ It cannot be changed easily
- ❖ It includes attitudes, values, interests, motives, and beliefs

The psychological core is built with a person after his birth, by the things a person looks, hears, and feels. So within it,

attitudes, values, interests, motives, and beliefs will be filled. This is more effective at younger ages but less effective while growing old. You have to move close to the sportsmen in order to understand the psychological core of themselves. With that, you will be able to understand the way how the particular sportsman's psychological core has been developed. By understanding the psychological core it is easy to understand the person's target and push them towards that target.

It is very dangerous to change the psychological core at once, even though it is filled with bad thoughts and attitudes. You have to correct them step by step. Also, it is very important to make sure that you help them with mental and physical support while slowly trying to change their negative and poor thoughts and attitudes.

Typical response

The way we learn to adjust to the environment or how we respond to the world around us is known as typical responses.

Typical responses are not as permanent as the psychological core, but typical responses are good indicators of the psychological core.

Role-related behaviour

- ❖ How a person acts based on what he perceives the social situation
- ❖ The most dynamic and changeable aspect of the personality
- ❖ Changes with external factors according to the situation
- ❖ This dynamic component allows the person to learn from the society

Role-related behavior can change at any time, so it is very dangerous to decide on an individual's personality just by looking at the role-related behavior.

Athlete burnout is one of the most frequent consequences of poor mental health, as well as one of the most discussed topics among sport psychologists. Interventions to reduce or mitigate this issue are still under investigation; thus, Wilczyńska et al. [5] conducted a systematic review with a meta-analysis to examine the psychological interventions carried out to help young athletes with burnout syndrome.

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] It is very difficult for a competitor to perform their sports activities with poor mental health. As they tend to collect reviews and feedback on their performances in order to develop their skill, it would not support a person with poor mental health in their development. Athletes from various family backgrounds do have psychological challenges that they have to face. The funds necessary to keep doing sports activities too have a special effect on an individual's psychology. In some instances, political factors too affect the psychology of sportsmen. Most often, educated people fail to encourage sportsmen due to various reasons, which can badly impact the psychological level of an individual.

To create an environment for sportsmen to excel in their sports performances we should mitigate this issue, by giving necessary knowledge about sports psychology to the sports trainers and

coaches, including physical trainers and first and supporters. Also promoting sports activities and giving necessary importance to sports will sport building a positive psychology of sportsmen and gradually develop their performance.

Conclusion

Previous studies show that sportsmen must have adequate nutrition and rest to increase performance. This is mainly to develop the mental well-being of an athlete. Therefore, it is understandable that both the physical and mental well-being should be considered when training an athlete.

Sports for an athlete becomes the most satisfying thing he does. By engaging in sports they will be able to learn a lot of new things and also adapt to situations at any time. Previous studies state that many sportsmen have a target of making sports become their main source of income, and are interested in making sports become their future career.

It is very important to conduct workshops and campaigns to educate the trainers and coaches so that they understand the value of this unspoken topic and implement all things that are necessary to develop an individual sports psychology.

Future expectations

The future for sports psychology is bright, with the ever-growing awareness of the importance of sports psychology to reach and remain in its peak performance. Other areas of research in the field can be, how technology affects mental training, the function and role of mindfulness and meditation in sport, and the psychological effects of sport on aging populations.

Basically, sports psychology stands at the connecting point between physical performance and mental well-being. Through the understanding of the psychological aspects of sport, and by giving attention to them, athletes will realize improved performances, challenges, and reach full potential. As the field continues to evolve, it is without a doubt that there will be more complexity and widespread emerge of psychological principles into athletic training at all levels of competition.